

Mastering the Debate: A Student's Guide

Debating isn't just about arguing—it's about using your brain (and your English!) to persuade others. Follow this guide to help your team win the next class battle.

The 5-Step Battle Plan

| Phase | Time | What to Do |

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| 1. Preparation | 2 Mins | Brainstorm! Write down why you agree or disagree. Use your target grammar (prefer, would rather, will/might). |

| 2. Opening | 1 Min | Captains only. Introduce your side. "Our team believes..." or "We disagree because..." |

| 3. Main Debate | 4-5 Mins | Everyone speaks. Share one opinion and one reason. Keep it short and sharp. |

| 4. Final Argument | 30 Secs | Captains only. Summarize your best points. "In conclusion..." or "To sum up..." |

| 5. Class Vote | 10 Secs | The moment of truth! Hands up for the winner. |

Your Role in the Team

To win, everyone must play their part. Your teacher will rotate these roles every debate!

- * The Captain: The leader. You open the debate and deliver the final punchline to convince the audience.

- * The Speakers: The heart of the team. Every speaker must give one opinion + one reason.

- * The Note Taker: The brain. You write down 3–5 ideas during prep and help teammates if they get stuck or forget their lines.

Pro Tips for B1 Success

To get the highest score, don't just say "I like it." Use the Target Grammar we've been practicing:

> Instead of: "I like books."

> Try: "I prefer reading because books are more detailed than movies."

> Instead of: "Movies are fast."

> Try: "I would rather watch a movie because it might be more exciting."

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How to Score Points:

- * ✓ Grammar Power: 1 Point (Using would rather, prefer, modals)

- * ✓ Clear Opinion: 1 Point (Did we understand you?)

- * ✓ Good Reason: 1 Point (Did you explain why?)

- * ✓ Respect: 1 Point (Listening while others speak)

- * ✓ Teamwork: 2 Bonus Points (Helping your teammates)

Example: Books vs. Movies

Topic: "The book is always better than the movie."

- * For Team (Speaker A): "I prefer books because they are more detailed."

- * Against Team (Speaker C): "I'd rather watch the movie because it's faster."

- * Captain For: "In conclusion, we believe books help your imagination grow."

- * Captain Against: "To sum up, we think movies are easier to enjoy with friends."

Ready to start?